

JAGGAER CONTENT BRIEF

Maverick Spend in US & UK Universities: What the Data Shows in 2026

TOFU · Geography: US · Target word count: 1,200–1,600 words · Primary ranking opportunity: maverick spend university data 2026 (KD n/a — no MSV/KD found for the stakeholder-set primary/secondary terms; see Section 2)

Brief at a glance

URL SLUG	/maverick-spend-university-data-2026
CONTENT TYPE	Data Snapshot — Maverick Spend & Governance cluster spoke (not the anchor).
TARGET WORD COUNT	1,200–1,600 words — a Data Snapshot spoke is stat-led, not comprehensive; word count follows from how many verified data points earn a place.
TARGET AUDIENCE	Higher-education finance and procurement leaders — primarily US, with UK context for comparison — who suspect off-contract spend is eroding budgets but haven't seen it quantified. TOFU.
FUNNEL / GEO / PATH	TOFU · Geography: US · Publishing Week 3 (per project card)
PRIMARY KEYWORD	maverick spend university data 2026 — stakeholder-specified, kept exactly as given. No MSV/KD data was found for this exact phrase. Drives H1/title/framing only.
SECONDARY KEYWORD	off-contract spend higher education UK US — stakeholder-specified, kept exactly as given. Same caveat: no exact-match keyword data found.
PILLAR PAGE LINK	No Higher Education pillar page exists yet. As a spoke, this piece should link up to the Maverick Spend & Governance cluster anchor once it's built — see Section 5.
PUBLISH PRIORITY	Medium-High — TOFU data snapshot with genuinely citable industry stats (E&I Cooperative Services/Hackett Group), but no US-vs-UK segmented comparison exists in any supplied source; flagging this data gap is itself part of the piece's honesty and part of Section 8's guidance to the writer.

1. Search intent analysis

The reader is a university finance or procurement leader who suspects departments are buying outside negotiated contracts, but hasn't seen it quantified with real numbers. TOFU: they want current data, not a generic definition of maverick spend they've read before.

What the reader needs to leave with

- Real, current estimates of how much maverick spend costs US higher-ed institutions in lost negotiated savings and sourcing leverage.
- Why decentralized campus purchasing (departments, faculty, p-cards) makes higher ed especially exposed to this problem compared to other sectors.
- Honesty about a genuine data gap: no source reviewed for this piece publishes a direct US-vs-UK segmented comparison of university maverick spend.
- A next step: understanding how guided buying and spend visibility close the gap between policy and actual purchasing behavior.

SERP features to target

Featured snippet — the clearest available current stat on maverick spend's cost to institutions, directly under the H1. People Also Ask — FAQ section (Section 6) reframed around “how much does this actually cost” rather than generic definitions.

Competitive intent note: a US higher-ed cooperative (E&I Cooperative Services, via ABACC) publishes a genuinely useful strategies-and-stats piece, but it's US-only and advice-framed, not a US/UK data comparison. Two competitor S2P vendors (Zycus, Pantavanij) publish generic “detect maverick spend” content with self-reported vendor stats (e.g. Zycus's own “nearly 30% of spend” and case-study figures) that shouldn't be cited as independent data. A Grant Thornton UK higher-education report and a HEPI funding-policy blog both touch UK university finances generally but not maverick spend specifically. A Wonkhe piece on student fee “set-off” rights is entirely unrelated — a different topic despite surface keyword overlap. No source gives a real US/UK comparison — that gap is this piece's opening, but it must be stated honestly, not filled with invented numbers.

STAKEHOLDER NOTE

No supplied or independently found source publishes a direct, segmented US-vs-UK comparison of university maverick/off-contract spend, despite the secondary keyword and title implying one. This piece should lead with verified US-specific figures, use the UK Grant Thornton HE sector report only for general financial-pressure context, and state plainly that a true country-by-country comparison isn't available yet rather than manufacturing one.

2. Target keywords

Primary

KEYWORD	MSV	KD	INTENT
maverick spend university data 2026	—	—	Stakeholder-set primary — drives H1/title/framing, unchanged
off-contract spend higher education UK US	—	—	Stakeholder-set secondary — kept as-is, unchanged

Supporting — chosen from the supplied keyword screenshots

KEYWORD	MSV	KD	INTENT
off contract spend	20 (US: 0) / 70 global	n/a	Informational — best head-term match; usable in intro and an H2
what is off contract spend	0	n/a	Informational — question-shaped, FAQ candidate despite 0 volume

Ultra-low KD callout: not applicable — no KD data was returned for any supplied term.

A separate 7-keyword “maverick spend platform” batch (0 total volume) was not used here. Terms like “top procurement platforms for reducing maverick spend 2026” are BOFU, vendor-comparison intent — a different piece’s angle (platform selection) than this TOFU data snapshot’s angle (quantifying the problem). Flagging it here in case there’s a home for it elsewhere in the content calendar, consistent with how off-angle keyword batches have been handled in prior briefs.

No corrections were made to the stakeholder-supplied primary/secondary keywords; no additional anchor terms were added beyond what’s shown above.

3. Recommended page structure

ELEMENT	CONTENT GUIDANCE
H1 (Title)	Maverick Spend in US & UK Universities: What the Data Shows in 2026 (kept exactly as specified)
Meta title	Maverick Spend in Universities: 2026 Data — 47 characters
Meta description	See what the current data shows about maverick and off-contract spend at US and UK universities. — 100 characters
Intro (100–150 words)	Snippet-ready: lead with the clearest available current stat (recommend the “up to 20% of negotiated savings lost” figure). State plainly this is a US-led data snapshot with UK context, not a segmented comparison — that data doesn't exist yet.
H2: What Maverick Spend Actually Costs US Universities	Lead stat: institutions lose up to 20% of negotiated savings on off-contract purchases (E&I Cooperative Services, citing iValua — verify against iValua's own publication before citing directly). Primary visual (Section 4) goes here.
H2: Why Decentralized Campuses Are Especially Exposed	Departments, faculty p-card purchases, and convenience buying proliferate in decentralized campus environments. Use “off contract spend” naturally here.
H2: The Sourcing-Leverage Problem	63% of organizations report off-contract spend reduces sourcing leverage (Hackett Group, via E&I/ABACC — verify against Hackett's own published research before citing).
H2: The UK Financial-Pressure Context	Use the OfS-sourced stat (via HEPI) that nearly half of UK universities are projected to be in deficit in 2025-26 as context for why spend-under-management matters now — not as a maverick-spend-specific figure. Be explicit this is context, not a direct comparison point.
H2: What Closes the Gap	Guided buying, spend analytics, and “No PO, No Pay” policy enforcement, per the E&I/ABACC piece. Secondary visual (Section 4) goes here.
H2: FAQ	6–8 questions — see Section 6.
H2: Next steps	Link up to the Maverick Spend & Governance cluster anchor once it exists, and to JAGGAER's Education vertical page (Section 5) — a genuinely verified, on-topic real page, not a placeholder.

4. Visual production notes

Primary visual

A simple stat callout: up to 20% of negotiated savings lost on off-contract purchases; 63% of organizations report reduced sourcing leverage from off-contract spend (Hackett Group). Appears within the first two scrolls, under the first H2.

Secondary visual (if applicable)

A simple two-column “Why It Happens” vs. “What Closes It” callout: convenience/decentralization drivers on one side, guided buying/spend analytics/policy enforcement on the other. Appears under “What Closes the Gap.”

Formatting notes: keep tables to 3–5 columns. Cite each figure's source directly beside it, and mark which figures are secondary-sourced (need verification) versus primary.

5. Internal linking plan

DESTINATION	ANCHOR TEXT	PLACEMENT
Cluster anchor — Maverick Spend & Governance	Does not exist yet — TBC. Update this piece's linking plan once the anchor publishes.	Intro; Next steps
Product — JAGGAER for Education (jaggaer.com/vertical/education-procurement)	“JAGGAER's higher-education spend management solutions” (verified real page — its own copy explicitly says “increase compliance and reduce rogue spending,” a direct match to this piece's topic)	What Closes the Gap; Next steps
External — Hackett Group research	“The Hackett Group's research” (verify direct source before publish)	The Sourcing-Leverage Problem
External — Office for Students (OfS)	“nearly half of UK universities project a 2025-26 deficit”	The UK Financial-Pressure Context

As a spoke, this piece should link up to the Maverick Spend & Governance cluster anchor once it's built, and that anchor's linking plan should be updated to point back down here.

6. FAQ targets

Each answer should be 2-3 sentences, written to target the PAA box. Answers must be self-contained — assume the reader may read only the FAQ.

- What is maverick spend in a university procurement context?
- What is off-contract spend, and how is it different from maverick spend?
- How much does maverick spend actually cost US universities?
- Why are universities especially exposed to off-contract purchasing?
- Does off-contract spend affect UK universities the same way as US universities?
- What reduces maverick spend most effectively on a decentralized campus?
- Is there reliable data comparing US and UK university maverick spend directly?

7. SEO and technical requirements

URL	/maverick-spend-university-data-2026 (no date beyond the year — treat as a snapshot piece)
Title tag	Maverick Spend in Universities: 2026 Data — 47 characters
Meta description	See what the current data shows about maverick and off-contract spend at US and UK universities. — 100 characters
Schema markup	Article + FAQPage schema on the FAQ section.
Update cadence	Review when E&I Cooperative Services, Hackett Group, or NACUBO publish new benchmarking data, or when a genuine US/UK segmented study becomes available.
Canonical	Self-canonical. Plan a full refresh if a direct US/UK comparison study is published — the current absence of one is itself time-sensitive information.
Disclaimer	Recommended: note that several figures are cited via a secondary source and should be verified against the original research (iValua, Hackett Group) before publication.

8. Recommended sources

List only primary sources: official documentation, regulatory text, government publications, peer-reviewed research, or official organization guidance.

- E&I Cooperative Services, via ABACC — “Maverick Spend in Higher Education: Risks, Impact, and Control Strategies” (published 14 May 2026, fetched and reviewed directly) — the clearest available US higher-ed figures, though several are themselves secondary-sourced (iValua, Hackett Group) and should be traced to the original research before publication.
- Office for Students — press release on 2025-26 financial projections (referenced via a HEPI blog; verify directly against the OfS’s own publication before citing) — UK financial-pressure context only, not a maverick-spend-specific figure.
- The Hackett Group — sourcing-leverage research, cited via the E&I/ABACC piece — locate and verify against Hackett’s own published report before citing directly.
- Grant Thornton UK — Higher Education Sector Development Report 2025 — supplied but not independently fetched for this brief; recommend the writer review directly for any additional UK financial-pressure context before drafting.

Source note: of the seven supplied SERP links, the E&I/ABACC piece was the most directly usable. Two (Zycus, Pantavanij) are competitor S2P vendor pages with self-reported stats that should not be cited as independent data. The Grant Thornton report was supplied but not independently fetched — verify directly. The HEPI blog concerns university funding policy broadly, not maverick spend, and was used only for one contextual OfS-sourced stat. The Wonkhe piece concerns student fee “set-off” consumer rights and is entirely unrelated to procurement or maverick spend — not used.

This brief was generated with no MSV/KD data for the stakeholder-set primary/secondary keywords, as none was found; supporting keywords were chosen from stakeholder-supplied screenshots (see Section 2). This document is not legal or financial advice.